

Boston Sunday Globe

Serving our community since 1872

JUNE 14, 2026



Joined together, by the sound of music

For these autistic students, jazz is their means of connection

By Mark Shanahan
GLOBE STAFF

RANDOLPH — Isaiah Pina is sitting quietly with an alto saxophone in his lap as other members of the Boston Higashi School jazz band filter into the room.

Kyle Brooks arrives with his trombone; Thomas Bernard is clutching a euphonium, a brass instrument that resembles a mini tuba; Jackson Odiet carries a trumpet; Danny Khattar takes his place behind a conga drum; and Carmine DeCicco plugs in his bass.

When the full band, which includes six current Higashi students, four alums, and five teachers, is finally in place, director Yoshino Stanbrook turns to face them.

“Good afternoon, everybody!” Stanbrook exclaims, smiling.

“Good afternoon!” the players respond eagerly.

In some ways, this is an ordinary scene — a school ensemble gathered to practice songs they’ll

HIGASHI, Page A4



PHOTOS BY CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

Top: Danny Khattar, 15, a percussionist in the Boston Higashi School jazz band, scans the crowd before the dress rehearsal of the Winter Music Festival in December. Above: Thomas Bernard, 25, waits to play his euphonium.

For Kraft, a different path to the World Cup this time around

By Emma Platoff and Janelle Nanos
GLOBE STAFF

Four decades ago, when the United States won its long-shot bid to host the 1994 Men’s World Cup, Boston was not in the game.

The US team hadn’t qualified for the World Cup in 40 years. New England did not have a professional soccer team. And Boston didn’t even register on early lists of possible host cities.

But Robert Kraft had an idea.

Back in 1988, Kraft was a paper and packaging magnate who didn’t yet own the Patriots, and had just bought Sullivan Stadium in Foxborough out of bankruptcy court. The 60,000-seat, Astroturfed stadium didn’t meet the specifications for professional soccer, but Kraft was looking to bring events to his new property. While traveling in Europe he saw soccer’s grip on the world and hoped to bring some of that magic here.

To help, he tapped Steven Gans, a young lawyer and former professional soccer player, who recalled Kraft telling him Boston came in dead last in an early assessment of possible US

KRAFT, Page A16



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

GAME DAY — Aicha Prenelus (left) of Randolph led Haiti fans in a song while waiting for their train at South Station to the World Cup. **B1.**

A powerful start

The US team’s 4-1 win over Paraguay was an opener to dream on, says John Powers. **Sports, C1, 10.**

Campaigns exploit a gray area with internet influencers

By Sophie Endrud
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Two political influencers, Kaitlyn Hennessy and Beatrice Gomberg, were scrolling their social media feeds on Mother’s Day when they noticed a collection of content supporting Tom Steyer, then a Democratic candidate for governor of California.

The accounts producing the posts had been created only a few days before and had very few followers. Gomberg, who runs a small business and supported Democrat Xavier Becerra, was surprised to see that the creators in question were based outside of California. Becerra went on to win the June 2 primary and will face Republican candidate Steve Hilton in the November general election. Still, the posts nagged at Gomberg.

“Ultimately, it comes down to it being deceptive,” she said. “Why is someone who’s registered in Pennsylvania telling you who to vote for in California?”

The two creators then discovered the Steyer campaign’s job listing on SideShift, a creator

INFLUENCERS, Page A14

Unbowed, Powell holds on at Fed

Rare survivor of Trump’s efforts to extend control

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Jerome Powell, the former head of the Federal Reserve, hunched under an umbrella with his wife, Elissa

THE END OF NORMALCY Leonard, as they hustled through a spring squall into the John F. Kennedy Presidential Library and Museum in Dorchester.

Later, as he prepared to address more than 700 people at a black tie dinner in a tent outside, another wave of heavy rain drummed on the roof.

The metaphor practically wrote itself. The agency Powell recently led, designed by Congress to be insulated from political influence because of its crucial role in the economy, has faced a storm of criticism from President Trump in his second term. And the soft-spoken Powell, 73, has been the lightning rod.

But, rare in Washington these days, Powell managed to survive the Trump tempest.

In May, he left the Fed chairmanship on his own terms, not

POWELL, Page A13

In the bright place

Sunday: Sun and clouds.
High: 89-94. Low: 66-71.
Monday: Mostly sunny.
High: 80-85. Low: 60-65.
Sunrise: 5:07 Sunset: 8:22
Complete report, **A24.**
Deaths, **A18-22.**

Meet the 50+ most influential people in the region’s tech sector as determined by Globe business journalists in the Tech Power Players edition of the **Globe Magazine.**

The Berkshires are known as a summer getaway spot for the wealthy, but not all Berkshires homes are out of reach for buyers with more modest budgets.
Address, H1.

Travel writer Christopher Muther offers a field guide to the folks you will see at the airport, including the Play-by-Play Mobile Phone Announcer (left).
SundayTravel, N13.

VOL. 309, NO. 165

Suggested retail price
\$6.00



Boost your savings with confidence.

GET A VARIABLE RATE UP TO

4.00% APY

for 6 months* on balances of \$25,000–\$10,000,000 with an Eastern Bank Money Market Plus

Earn up to 4.00% Annual Percentage Yield* with a 6-month interest rate boost. 180 days after account opening, the APY will revert to the standard, variable APY of up to 3.25%. Rates are subject to account balances.

Apply now at EasternBank.com/MoneyMarket or visit your local branch.

Eastern Bank
JOIN US FOR GOOD®

Balances	Standard APY*	Boosted APY*	Blended APY*
\$10–\$24,999	0.01%	0.74%	0.37%
\$25,000–\$10,000,000	3.25%	4.00%	3.62%
\$10,000,000.01+	0.01%	0.74%	0.37%

*Annual Percentage Yield (APY) is accurate as of 6/12/2026. This offer, interest rates, or APY are subject to change at any time without notice at the discretion of the Bank. Fees may reduce earnings. Minimum Deposit Requirement for opening account: \$25,000 and must be new money not already on deposit with Eastern Bank. Offer limited to one account per taxpayer identification number. Please refer to the Personal Deposit Account Agreement for details.

Member FDIC.